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Cyclist's death prompts pledges

Wu vows safer streets; advocates vow more pressure

By Niki Griswold
GLOBE STAFF

The city of Boston will ramp up protections for bike lanes, including cracking down on illegal parking, and more broadly revive other street safety programs following the death of a City Hall transportation planner who was struck and killed by a truck last week while cycling on busy Tremont Street.

The enhanced effort to improve street safety is a marked pivot for City Hall and comes as Mayor Michelle Wu was subject to blistering criticism from bike safety advocates for slow-walking and in some cases pulling back on critical safety improvements. They delivered a letter to City Hall during a vigil Thursday night demanding swift action, saying the death of the cyclist, Louisa Gag, could have been prevented if better safety protocols were in place.

That tension was palpable during the vigil outside City Hall as Wu took to the podium herself and vowed to deliver on street improvements that the angry, grieving audience had been pressing for long before the death of a colleague who had dedicated her work to the cause.

"We just want to see change and want to see it happen quick, and only that will make things better," said Peter Cheung, a longtime bike safety advocate who was among the crowd of hundreds of mourners.

Earlier in her career, Gag had been an intern for Wu when the latter was a city councilor. Speaking at the vigil, a visibly emotional Wu vowed to "deliver on that vision" Gag had for safer

CYCLING, Page A7

A record-tying nine ballot questions have been certified to appear on this fall's ballot. **B1.**

The United States and Iran escalated their attacks across the Middle East, with both infrastructure and military sites targeted. **A4.**

Citizens Financial Group ended its ties with two operators that oversee detention facilities for ICE after facing protests at its bank offices. **D1.**

Make it 11 wins in a row for the Red Sox, as they sweep a double-header against the division-leading Rays. **C1.**



Crack, the whip.

Saturday: Storm late, windy. High 83-88, low 68-73.

Sunday: Clearing cooler. High 79-84, low 64-69.

High tide: 2:40, 3:15.

Sunrise: 5:23. Sunset: 8:17.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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Ex-wives accuse ICE agent of violence

Searing allegations made in divorce proceedings with man who reportedly killed immigrant in Maine

By Giulia McDonnell
Nieto del Rio, Lea Skene,
and Mike Damiano
GLOBE STAFF

AUGUSTA, Maine — David Brouillette, identified as the ICE agent who shot and killed a Colombian immigrant in Maine this week, was accused by two ex-wives of violent and threatening behavior.

On Thursday, one of the women filed a court document alleging Brouillette once

threatened to kill her with a gun. The other, Ashley Brouillette, said in an interview with the Globe that he had choked her, slammed her to the floor, and once threw boiling water on her.

Both allegations were made amid messy divorce proceedings in which Brouillette also accused each woman of domestic abuse.

Attempts to reach David Brouillette Thursday and Fri-

day were unsuccessful.

Federal officials have not publicly identified Brouillette as the shooter. But Ashley Brouillette, who was married to him from 2007 to 2009, said that she spoke to him on Wednesday and that he acknowledged his role in the shooting. "He kept saying it was justified," she said.

The Portland Press-Herald also identified Brouillette as the shooter.

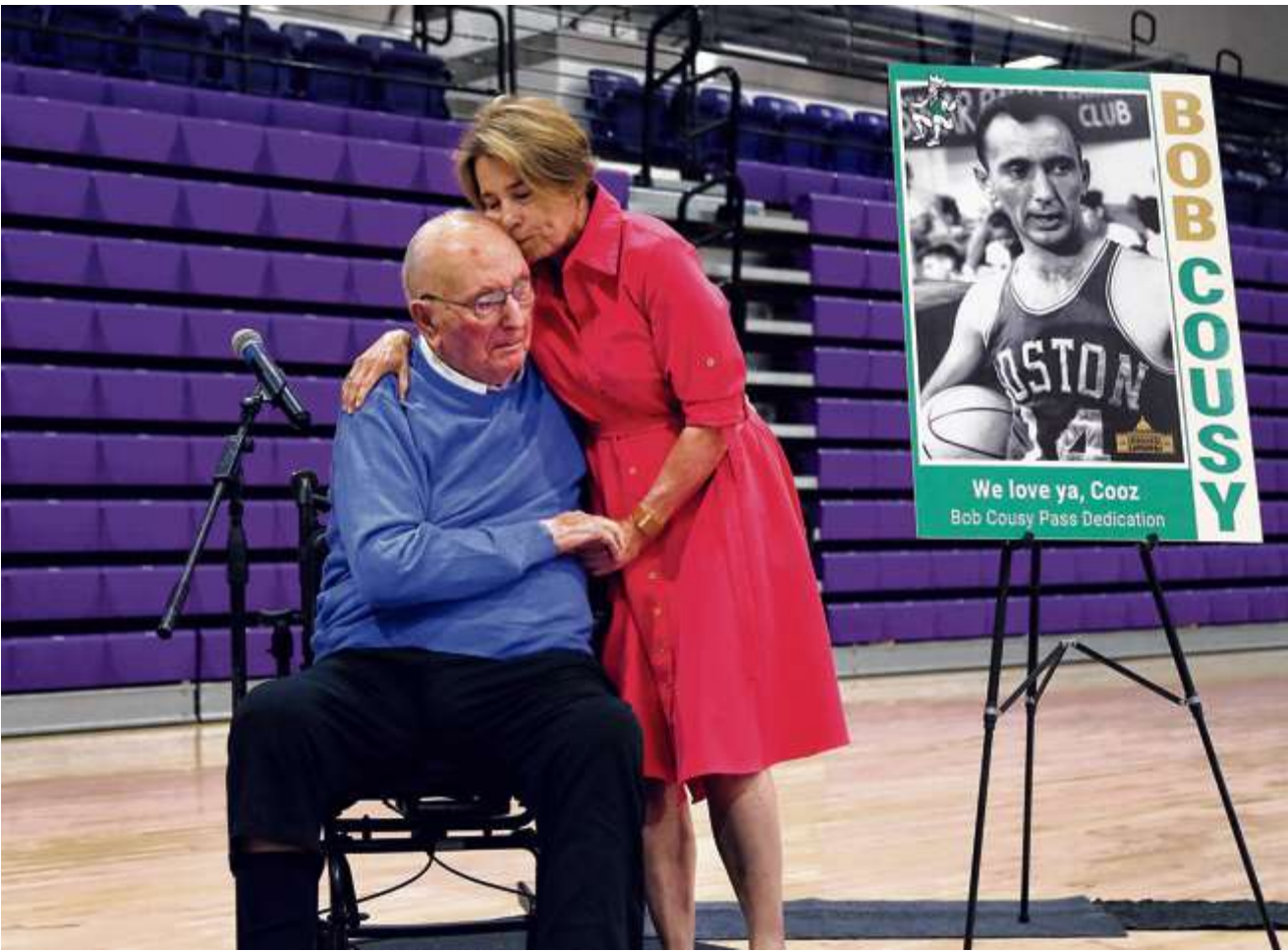
The revelations about Brouillette's past come amid an outcry over the killing of Johan Sebastián Durán Guerrero in Biddeford on Monday. It is the latest fatal shooting by federal immigration officials agents since the Trump administration deployed thousands of new ICE agents as part of its nationwide immigration crackdown; just six days earlier, in Texas, another immigrant was shot and killed in his truck during a traffic stop by ICE agents. He too was reportedly not the intended target of their attempted stop.

The shootings have renewed criticism that ICE has hired unqualified applicants in its rush to staff up for Trump's crackdown. Many law enforcement experts also question the training provided to agents, saying their behavior during traffic stops violates widely accepted police procedures.

Durán Guerrero was shot Monday while he was behind the wheel of a car outside his family's apartment. Authorities have said little about the circumstances of the shooting and many key details remain

AGENT, Page A10

WITH AN ASSIST, FROM THE GOVERNOR



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

A dedication ceremony for a bridge named after Boston Celtics' legendary guard Bob Cousy was held at the College of the Holy Cross Friday. Governor Maura Healey presided over the event. The Interstate-290 bridge over Southbridge Street in Worcester is now known as the Bob Cousy Pass. The Celtics all-time leader in assists turns 98 next month.

Two decades on lam ends in 56-foot sailboat

Ex-anesthesiologist had skipped R.I. sex assault trial



Ronald L. Fischer was convicted in absentia of first-degree sexual assault.

By Christopher Gavin
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — When authorities found him, cruising in a sailboat named The Silver Lining off the coast of New Jersey this week, one of the most-wanted fugitives in Rhode Island had been on the run for more than 20 years.

Ronald L. Fischer, now 70, a former anesthesiologist from East Greenwich, R.I., had gone on the lam during his 2005 trial for first-degree sexual assault in

Portsmouth, R.I.

A team of federal and Rhode Island investigators assigned to track down violent fugitives, said it recently received new information about his whereabouts and located him about an hour offshore of New Jersey. His 56-foot sailboat was registered to Richard Graydon, an alias, officials said.

"This arrest demonstrates that time does not erase accountability," Wing Chau, US marshal for the District of

Rhode Island, said in a statement.

Maybe so, but some who've been involved in Fischer's case over the years had begun to believe he would never be found.

"I was surprised," said Carl Ricci, a now-former prosecutor who tried the case against Fischer in Newport County Superior Court more than two decades ago. "I just figured, you know, he made it this long, I just thought [he's] probably going to make it for the rest of his life — if he's alive."

It was not clear on Friday

FUGITIVE, Page A10

Strategy on Alzheimer's may shift into multifront battle

Latest study shows promise on ways to target tau protein

By Allyson Chiu
GLOBE STAFF

What if there were more than one way to treat Alzheimer's?

After years of hits and misses trying to unlock the mysteries of Alzheimer's disease, experts say recent research has yielded results that could reshape how doctors care for patients with the irreversible brain disorder that currently has no cure.

An experimental drug that targets a different brain protein than current treatments appeared to slow early stages of cognitive decline in patients, according to clinical trial results an-

nounced this week. The findings unlock the possibility of tackling Alzheimer's from multiple angles.

Researchers are working to target the full "constellation" of processes that drive Alzheimer's with the goal of being able to one day deliver individualized treatments, said Dr. Adam Boxer, a professor of memory and aging at the University of California San Francisco, who was not involved in the new trial.

"This is just the beginning," Boxer said.

There are two main brain proteins linked to Alzheimer's: amyloid and tau.

Two drugs that have been approved for Alzheimer's, including one from Cambridge-based Biogen, take aim at amyloid, the sticky protein that

ALZHEIMER'S, Page A6

CAST AGAINST AN OMINOUS SKY



FINN GOMEZ/GETTY IMAGES

An ochre haze from wildfire smoke formed the backdrop to the Marine Corps War Memorial as the sun rose Friday in Washington, D.C. Cities across the United States still dealt with unhealthy air quality. **A2.**

Housing official quits amid questions

Developers tied to his home had received grants

By Joey Flechas
and Gordon Russell
GLOBE STAFF

A state housing executive at the center of a controversy involving two developers who appeared to have submitted fraudulent invoices for government-backed affordable housing projects has resigned.



FOLLOW-UP

The executive, Tony Richards II, had awarded the developers \$1.4 million for the work — most of which was either poorly done or not done at all — shortly after they sold him his home in West Roxbury for far less than the original list price.

Richards, who previously served as deputy chief of staff to then-Governor Charlie Baker, earned \$255,000 a year as vice president for strategic community initiatives at MassHousing. His resignation Friday came three weeks after the Globe Spotlight Team exposed serious problems with a program that was supposed to rehabilitate affordable housing units in struggling mill towns across the Commonwealth.

The Globe found that the two developers who received the \$1.4 million in grants — more than half the money given out in the program — had submitted fake invoices to MassHousing. At least nine subcontractors told the

RESIGNATION, Page A7